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ASUS ROG Strix X570-E Gaming

Feature-rich and classy

ASUS has built up quite the portfolio for its X570 chipset. There's a board for every budget and the X570-E Gaming sits in the centre of the lineup. It differentiates itself from the X570-F Gaming by including an additional LAN port (which happens to be 2.5G), Intel AX200 Wi-Fi and Bluetooth 5.0 chip. It also has three full-length PCIe x16 slots. At ₹27K, this isn't a cheap board by any metric but then again, with the X570 chipset, none of the new boards are.

Packaging

ASUS' STRIX branding makes use of black prominently with red and grey accents. The packaging looks fairly simple with the key elements highlighted.

Contents

Being a mid-range board, you don't get a lot with this motherboard but there is additional value in the form of the thermistors, Wi-Fi antennae, and extension cables for RGB and ARGB LED strips.

Board Layout

The ROG Strix X570-E Gaming is a full-sized ATX board. The board makes use of a 6-phase VRM design that's spread over 12 power stages. All of them are covered with a heatsink and it even has a heat pipe running through it. The heatsink is made from two machined aluminium blocks and isn't a well-spaced fin stack. Either way, it gets the job done with regards to cooling the MOSFETs.

Speaking of VRMs, it makes use of Infineon IR35201 configured in an 6+2 mode without any doublers. For the power stages, it uses Infineon IR3555 for the CPU VCC and IR3553 for the SoC. For the memory, it uses a Vishay SiR-A14DP which is rated for 58 A. Overall, the VRM is capable of handling the high current demands of overclocking even



Price
₹27,499



the top-end AMD SKUs.

The four RAM sockets are closely packed with release levers on just one side. Thankfully, they're on the top, so removing the DIMMs shouldn't be a pain and won't require you to remove the GPU first.

There is a lot of shielding around the expansion slots. It maintains a clean aesthetic by melding the NVMe heatsinks with the dust guards. Underneath the dust guard lies the PCH fans which have become common on the X570 boards owing to the high TDP of the PCH. Blame PCIe 4.0, if you will. With the 3rd Gen Ryzen platform, the processor can do x24 PCIe 4.0 lanes of which x16 are for graphics, x4 for NVMe and x4 for the downlink to the chipset. So PCIe full-length slots get their bandwidth from the processor as well as the PCH when all three slots are populated.

For audio, the ASUS ROG Strix X570-E Gaming uses a Realtek ALC1220 which offers 7.1 channel audio output and you have the usual bunch of "audio caps" with it. Also included are dual OPAMPs and the entire assembly together is called SupremeFX S1220A. ASUS has also included a DTS software solution which has three profiles –

Soundscape, Aerial and Tactical mode. All profiles are geared to provide positional cues. Tactical mode will put-up an overlay on your game screen to provide visual cues for the audio direction.

The rear I/O has a sufficient set of connectivity options. There are three USB 3.1 Gen 2 Type-A ports, one USB 3.1 Gen 2 Type-C and four USB 3.1 Gen 1 Type-A ports but no PS/2 port. You can hardly find any high-end or mid-range keyboard with this legacy port anyway so there's no love lost there. Then there's a DP and HDMI port for video output should you have an APU installed. A 2.5G LAN port and an Intel LAN port alongside which lie the SMA connectors for the Wi-Fi antennae. Then there's audio jacks and lastly, a BIOS flashback button above the USB ports. Ideally, we'd like these buttons to have some sort of protection to prevent accidental presses. At the time of testing, the board was still using AGESA 1.0.0.3 which allows the AMD processors to properly hit the advertised frequencies.

Verdict

With the X570 platform's unique features, both the power requirements and pricing have gone up considerably. Until now, an AMD system used to be cheaper to build but with the X570 platform that advantage is gone. This very board costs ₹27,499 which would have otherwise cost around 20K on the X470 platform with a similar feature set. Still, the ASUS ROG Strix X570-E Gaming is a well-rounded board that's designed to make the most of AMD's new platform.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

CHIPSET: Intel X570 | MEMORY SUPPORT: 4x4000(OC)MHz upto 128GB | LAN: intel I211-AT GbE, Realtek RTL8125-CG 2.5G | AUDIO: SupremeFX S1220A | SATA: 8x SATA III | EXPANSION: 2x PCIe x16(x16,x8/x8) | DIMENSIONS (LxWxD): 305 mm x 244 mm | WARRANTY: 3 years.

CONTACT

ASUS TECHNOLOGY PVT. LTD. | PHONE: +18002090365 | EMAIL: reachus@asus.com | WEBSITE: www.asus.in